

**Port**

In networking, a server's various functions, such as managing FTP traffic or maintaining the DNS list, are each assigned a virtual address called a port. Any requests for that function are sent to the port address. Some common functions are assigned standard port numbers by the IANA (Internet Assigned Numbers Authority); for instance, DNS traffic is always routed to port 53.

**Port Forwarding**

This lets a computer external to a secured network access a computer on the network through the mapping of a port on the network's firewall to a port on a specified computer. This allows a firewall to block certain connections using certain port and protocol combinations while permitting predetermined port connections on specified computers.

**PPP**

Point-to-Point Protocol. PPP is the Internet standard for serial communications. Newer and better than its predecessor, Serial Line Internet Protocol (SLIP), PPP defines how your modem connection exchanges data packets with other systems on the Internet.

**PPTP**

Point-to-Point Tunnelling Protocol. PPTP is a protocol developed by a number of companies, including Microsoft, that allows secure transmission of data in TCP/IP packets. PPTP and similar protocols are used to carry secure communications over Virtual Private Networks that use public phone lines.

**Protocol**

Because so many different types of computers and operating systems connect via modems or other connections, they have to follow communications standards called protocols. The Internet is a heterogeneous collection of networked computers and is full of different protocols, including PPP, TCP/IP, SLIP, and FTP.